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VOGUE
September 2026

PRINTS AND REPEAT
"IT'S OKAY TO THROW THE RACKET," SAYS SABALENKA, DRESSED IN A GUCCI DRESS AND HEELS AND WEARING HER OWN RING. "IT'S OKAY TO YELL. IT'S OKAY TO GO NUTS. SOMETIMES YOU JUST NEED TO LET IT GO." AUDEMARS PIGUET WATCH. PHOTOGRAPHED BY STEVEN KLEIN.

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Two decades after he was heralded as the savior of classical music, conductor Gustavo Dudamel has lost none of his vim or vigor. Mattie Kahn catches up with him just before he takes the helm of the New York Philharmonic

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Dudamel's arrival at the Philharmonic has triggered a rhapsody in the city's classical-music scene—particularly among the young virtuosos of the Juilliard School

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Cover Look Arm Candy
Kaia Gerber and Homer Gere wear Chanel. To get Gerber's look, try: Pure Radiant Tinted Moisturizer SPF 30, Laguna Bronzing Powder, The Multiple in Hot Take, Quad Eyeshadow in Koh Rong, Brow Shaping Gel, Notorious Mascara, Afterglow Lip Shine in Abbey Road. All by Nars. Hair, Guido Palau; makeup, Pat McGrath. Details, see In This Issue.
Photographer: Steven Meisel.
Fashion Editor: Spencer Singer.

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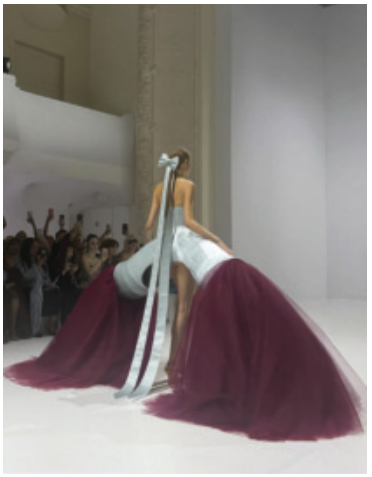
Letter From the Editor



THEN AND NOW
CLOCKWISE FROM LEFT: KAIA GERBER, IN CHLOÉ AND AN OMEGA WATCH, AND HOMER GERE, IN PRADA, PHOTOGRAPHED BY STEVEN MEISEL. JEAN PAUL GAULTIER IN PARIS, AND MY DAUGHTER, ALICE, ON A BEACH IN SOUTH CAROLINA—TWO SUMMER HIGH POINTS. CINDY CRAWFORD AND RICHARD GERE'S 1992 COVER, PHOTOGRAPHED BY HERB RITTS.

Time Machine

PATRIMOINE. THAT WAS THE FRENCH WORD I heard over and over in Paris while attending couture shows and jewelry appointments in July. The tension was all about protecting heritage while bringing history forward—equally true when it came to Cartier's panthers and Matthieu Blazy's techno tweeds.

The weight of heritage is not unknown to me. I grew up in the shadows of impressive parents who couldn't help but affect the way people think of me. It's taken me time to find my own identity and carve my own space, and I try to handle that pressure as I have approached taking the helm at *Vogue:* by letting myself be inspired by legacy and history rather than buckling under the weight of both.

Our September cover stars are models of forging your own path with grace. Shot by Steven Meisel, Kaia Gerber and Homer Gere wear a variety of looks from new creative directors at storied fashion houses, all of whom are taking the classic codes of those maisons and reinterpreting them by adding their own distinctive stamp.

The occasion for this is *The Shards,* a slick, spooky series adaptation from Ryan Murphy of Bret Easton Ellis's 2023 best-selling novel about a serial killer trolling Los Angeles in the early 1980s. The casting seems designed to attract attention, conjuring memories of Homer's father and Kaia's mother's legendary 1990s romance (and their Herb Ritts *Vogue* cover from 1992). Homer and Kaia are *not* a couple, of course—and they got their shared history out of the way when they met. As Homer told our writer Rob Haskell, one of the first things he said to Kaia was "'Should we just acknowledge the fact that our parents were married?' She was like, 'Yeah. Cool.' And that was it." Both are thoughtful but unbothered on the subject of having famous parents. "I've only ever been a nepo baby, and I've only ever benefited in my career from it," Kaia says. "But what that's done for me is make me want to work harder."

Elsewhere in the issue, Nathan Heller reports on Demna's first collections for Gucci—a collision of past and present—and Gaby Wood meets Marta Ortega Pérez, the head of Zara, who inherited its stewardship but who has pushed it in personal and modern directions. And there's the New York Philharmonic's new maestro, Gustavo Dudamel, who brings a rush of energy to every room he enters. Bring on Dudamania!

Malle

KAIA GERBER AND HOMER GERE: FASHION EDITOR: SPENCER SINGER. GAULTIER AND ALICE: COURTESY OF CHLOE MALLE. CINDY CRAWFORD AND RICHARD GERE: PHOTOGRAPHED BY HERB RITTS, *VOGUE*, NOVEMBER 1992.

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THE SOUND OF MUSIC
LEFT: PRINCIPAL BASSIST TIMOTHY COBB, VIOLIST LEAH FERGUSON, PRINCIPAL CLARINETIST ANTHONY MCGILL, VIOLIST TABITHA RHEE, AND CELLIST CLAIRE DEOKYONG KIM OF THE NEW YORK PHILHARMONIC. ABOVE: PHOTOGRAPHER THEO WENNER. BELOW: FLAUTIST PHOEBE RAWN, VIOLINIST MAYA KILBURN, PIANIST JUDE GIDDENS, CELLIST ARI PERAZA-WEBB, AND OBOIST CELIA WOJCIK OF JUILLIARD.

In Good Company

Styled by the Oscar-nominated *Marty Supreme* costume designer Miyako Bellizzi, "Reaching Crescendo" (page 342) is a story abuzz with real Juilliard musicians and members of the New York Philharmonic. "I wanted to celebrate the spirit of the students' lives," Bellizzi says of her fashion vision for the young talents, "and give them the opportunity to really shine."

Theo Wenner (AT TOP RIGHT, with cellist Claire Deokyong Kim) photographed them all at Lincoln Center, ringing in a new era in the city's classical-music scene as Gustavo Dudamel arrives (more on that in Mattie Kahn's profile of the conductor, "Ahead of the Beat," page 338). On set, according to producer and Juilliard alumna Juliette Kenn de Balinthazy, the students put on an impromptu show. As they posed with their instruments, one of them started playing, and the rest soon joined in. "For them, it's a reflex," Kenn de Balinthazy says.

SET DESIGN: JULIA WAGNER. WENNER: GREGORY BIRKHOFER.

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Some Personal News

The end of her marriage caught political reporter Annie Karni by surprise. Maybe that was why she couldn't stop talking about it.

During the first summer after my separation, I didn't mean to tell the people running this country that I was getting divorced— it just kept coming out. I've always been a fairly open book. But when my marriage ended abruptly in the summer of 2025, I felt a frantic need to tell everyone what had happened.

Maybe it was a bid for sympathy. Or I was in shock. I wondered if this was my way of putting it out into the world that I was available. Perhaps I was looking for advice. Mostly I felt I had no other way of making clear that I was going through a profound but invisible change in identity.

The ending of my 10-year marriage came at me fast and seemingly from out of nowhere, but nothing like this really happens out of nowhere. I can only explain my side of the street: Just before I got married in 2015, I joined *Politico* to cover the presidential campaign. We lived in Brooklyn at the time, and the campaign immediately took me on the road for much of the following year.

Then came Trump's first term, and with it a move to Washington, DC, for my job; then a first baby; a new job at *The New York Times;* a pandemic; a rescue puppy; a second baby; a new beat covering the maelstrom of Congress; a book deal. I was living in the double-blast zone of the national news cycle and new parenthood, my attention constantly elsewhere. His attention ended up elsewhere too—that is his story to tell.

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TALK THERAPY
"I DIDN'T WANT TO BE AN OVERSHARER," WRITES KARNI, "I WAS A JOURNALIST!"

PHOTOS: GETTY IMAGES. COLLAGE BY *VOGUE*.

The future looks vintage.

Fashion insiders buy and sell on eBay.

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But for years I had carried a low-grade awareness that our marriage had begun to resemble a series of transactions: trading off who was going out and who was staying in, taking turns living our lives. Mostly I chalked it up to these being particularly demanding years. I told myself any marriage between two young professionals with small children would resemble ours. Sometimes, though, that famous Stanley Tucci line from *The Devil Wears Prada* rang in my ears: "Let me know when your whole life goes up in smoke. Means it's time for a promotion." This kind of peaceful if distant coexistence was just how it sometimes went in a long relationship, I figured.

Nobody in my immediate family was divorced; it just wasn't something I even considered. So when the marriage abruptly fell apart, beginning with a conversation he initiated as he fed the dog her nightly treats and I thought I was about to go to bed, I felt a mix of shock, relief, and regret.

That summer, all sensations felt heightened. I listened to so much music. Taylor Swift songs felt profound. I talked on the phone to friends for hours as if I were in high school again. I ate carrot ginger soup and not much else. At night I felt alone, but no more or less alone than I'd been feeling for a long time. Living with the uncertainty about what the future might hold was exciting, overwhelming, an intellectual challenge as well as an emotional one. I had no idea what would come next.

"I am thinking about how happy I am," I wrote in my journal one day that summer. "Very sad," just a few days later. "I don't know who or what I am crying about."

For years I had carried a low-grade awareness that our marriage had begun to resemble a series of transactions: trading off who was going out and who was staying in, taking turns living our lives

One thing that did feel good was working. My editor kindly asked me if I needed a break or wanted to slow down. She said she would follow my lead on these matters. I said to pile it on. Which is why, for a few weeks there, I just couldn't shut up about the fact that I was getting divorced in every corridor of power in Washington.

One Thursday afternoon in July, I sat across the table from Senator Chuck Schumer in a small office at the Democratic Senatorial Campaign Committee.

That day, he had his campaign hat on, so instead of occupying his ornate office at the Capitol he was stuffed behind a metal desk in a drab room in the Democratic Party headquarters, conducting back-to-back interviews in order to disseminate talking points about winning back the Senate. I tried pushing him for specifics, about the map or the candidates he was trying to recruit in key states, but he would not budge. Schumer is very good at repeating the same thing, over and over, when he doesn't want to say more.

"What are you doing this summer?" he asked as I gathered up my things to go.

"I'm getting divorced," I volunteered.

He peered at me over those famous bifocals that are always about to slip off the tip of his nose.

"How old are your kids?" he asked me. My daughter was three and my son was seven.

"Men are so stupid," he said, shaking his head. "Just so stupid."

He had not pried for any details, simply drawn a quick conclusion, and I took this reaction like I would take it from a well-meaning distant relative at a family gathering: not particularly revelatory, but a somewhat reassuring conversation nonetheless. Sometimes it just feels good for someone to shake their head on your behalf.

The kids were, in fact, all right. My daughter would have no memories of our family arrangement before the split. My son was mostly just excited to have bunk beds in his dad's new house. We did not use the word *divorce,* but my son lived in the world and was searching for it. "What's it called when you have two houses?" he asked me. "It's just called having two houses," I said. When the divorce was finalized many months later, I told him that the big thing in his life had already happened when he started living in two houses and that the official change was just a piece of paper.

A few weeks after my Schumer interview, I was grocery shopping at Whole Foods, picking up the dreaded sunflower butter (the only nut-adjacent spread allowed at school) when Representative Nancy Mace, the South Carolina Republican, returned a call.

I had written a lot about Mace in the past, but I hadn't spoken to her in a long time. Aside from tormenting the sole out transgender member of Congress by waging a campaign to bar her from using the women's bathroom in the Capitol, Mace had been a side player that year.

But she came roaring back as a person of interest when she defied President Trump to force a vote to have the Department of Justice release unredacted Epstein files. She had positioned herself as a defender of women as well as a defender of Trump, and I wanted to hear how she planned to thread this tricky needle.

"How are you?" Mace asked.

"I'm okay, I'm getting divorced," I said, because, as I mentioned, I couldn't help myself.

Mace was a 47-year-old divorced mother of two. "Well, you just have to realize you're going to be alone for a long time," she said. "You're just gonna spend a lot of time alone."

She was right, I was spending longer stretches than I was accustomed to alone.

"But I'm married to the job," she added.

We moved on, back to our roles in the jobs we were both married to. "I fully support transparency on this issue," she said of the Epstein files.

I was aware that gleaning life lessons from the likes of Chuck Schumer and Nancy Mace was not a conventional mode of summoning a support system. These were politicians—their primary focus was themselves. (I expect a call for a correction here to say that their focus is on their constituents.) Either way, >174

JENNIFER LAWRENCE

Elegance is an attitude

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I was not a constituent, so they really only considered me in relation to what I could do for or to them.

But there was something that compelled me to keep telling them my personal news: It was as if I was trying on my new identity and seeing how it fit with my professional one, making sure that one was still intact.

Still, I didn't want to be an oversharer. I was a journalist! So a few weeks later, when Steve Bannon returned a call at a low moment, I tried to pull myself together to ask him to weigh in on Representative Marjorie Taylor Greene's recent comments on Gaza, in which she called the crisis a "genocide." But I was kind of holding back tears—I had gotten very good at crying, viewing it simply as a cleansing bodily function, like sneezing—and we both could tell and that was slightly awkward. So I told him why. He wanted the details. And then he told me to pull it together.

"You're Annie fucking Karni," he said. "Come on, girl."

For all of Bannon's democracy-threatening faults—promoting the lie that the 2020 election was stolen, leading the calls for an unconstitutional third term of Donald Trump, promoting extremism and conspiracy theories of all kinds—in this particular moment, I think he was just being kind.

We got back to the subject at hand, more comfortable territory for us all. "Marjorie Taylor Greene just reflects her constituency," he said. "I don't think she's an outlier at all."

The world, it ticked on. Trump's Medicaid-slashing domestic policy bill was so deeply unpopular that it could help Democrats win back the Senate. And Trump's failure to release the Epstein files was driving a wedge between the president and his base. And Greene's break with Trump on Israel hinted at a growing foreign policy rift on the right. And I was getting divorced, in case you missed it.

As busy weeks rolled by and I rearranged the house, burned sage, wallpapered my bedroom, took the trash bins out on Sunday nights and wheeled them back in on Monday mornings, the urge to talk to everyone I covered about my divorce began to subside. I went back to conducting interviews without inserting my personal life into the conversation, and that was probably for the best for everyone.

I had now told enough people that I began to notice a pattern. There is a formula for responding to a pregnant woman that doesn't require much thought. What week are you? How are you feeling? Do you know what you're having? Oh, boys are the best; oh, girls are the best. Cherish every moment, etc., etc.

Divorce may be almost as common, and marks another massive change. But it's less clear what you're supposed to say. I'm sorry? Congratulations? I've found that the correct answer is to say both. Maybe people should ask you what week you are, because the emotional landscape does seem to shift on a week-to-week basis in that first trimester of a separation.

About a year later, I found myself interviewing representatives Lauren Boebert and Anna Paulina Luna, two showboat MAGA congresswomen, for a story about sexual harassment on Capitol Hill. I was settling into the shared-custody schedule and my new life, with its new ups and downs, and mostly I was enjoying it. The reality of divorce is that in some ways it means acquiring a second life, and getting to be multiple selves at the same time. You are still the grown-up, parent version of yourself. But you are also returned, at least part-time, to a previous, younger-feeling solo version that is nice to meet up with again after a long separation. A year in, the out-of-body feeling had subsided. Pop music was seeming less profound. My diet had expanded beyond vats of monochrome vegetable soup. A look back at my journal from this time reports that there was now "more appetite, less feeling like something intense is happening even when nothing is happening."

Divorce may be almost as common as becoming a parent. But it's less clear what you're supposed to say. I'm sorry? Congratulations? I've found that the correct answer is to say both

Boebert, for her part, had a hardened view of cheaters on Capitol Hill, which appeared to be informed by her own experience. "My best friend was a little skank and she ruined my marriage," Boebert said when I asked her about the charge to rid Congress of sexual harassers (many of whom are married men).

That must have been hard, I answered, noting that my marriage had also ended recently. It was just becoming part of who I was, giving me a new way to relate, letting me see layers in others that might have previously gone unnoticed. Life can go sideways for anyone.

"I'm sorry about your marriage," Luna said to me softly after I turned off the tape recorder. They each offered me a slightly awkward hug, an unusual way to end an interview.

When I saw Bannon later that summer, I admitted to him that his "first name fucking last name" pep talk had been as effective as any I'd received.

He said I looked happier. And he warned me it was still no time to be giving my heart away to anybody new. (Steve Bannon, relationship counselor. The world is full of surprises.)

My summer of sharing was awkward, but it had helped settle me, helped me realize that I was still me, even in transition, and that you get the support you ask for.

When my daughter was born in 2021, I received a letter marking the occasion from Hillary Clinton, whose failed presidential campaign I had covered five years earlier. "I send my best wishes to you for a lifetime of amazing adventures and accomplishments, with those who love you cheering you along the way," she wrote to my newborn daughter.

Here we were less than four years later, and I jokingly asked my friend who had worked for Clinton for many years whether he could convince her to write me a divorce letter, to mark another new phase of life. I suggested that she could even recycle the same language: "I send my best wishes to you for a lifetime of amazing adventures and accomplishments, with those who love you cheering you along the way." I would have framed it too. □

Starring Olivia Munn
Shot by Emma Beiles Howie
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Same Again

The artist Taryn Simon has dressed in variations of the same outfit for years. On the eve of a major exhibition, she explains why. Photographed by Thomas Dozol.

An artist's outfit can send different messages: Georgia O'Keeffe in her austere blacks and whites, Picasso in his Breton stripe, photographer Bill Cunningham pedaling through New York City in his French sanitation workers kit. If you've been walking the streets of Manhattan for enough years, you might have caught a glimpse of another artist in a signature ensemble: Taryn Simon, wearing a skirt that hits just below the knee, held up by suspenders, with a moderate balloon-sleeve blouse tucked in beneath.

Simon's consideration, at the outset, was practical: Much of her work is photographic, and she needed her hands free, a pocket for her light meter, and also somewhere to stash her wallet. "I never wanted to carry a bag," she says. But there was a deeper evaluation taking place as well: to present herself respectably, without excess formality. Some of Simon's best-known work—portraits of men exonerated by DNA evidence, for instance, or photographs of Ukrainian children living in an orphanage—necessitates an air of composed respect.

That she would devise and refine this outfit herself is not that surprising. Simon was raised in New York by a mother who made almost all her clothing and who taught her to sew. Nothing was thrown away in their household, and whenever a functional object—a box to hold papers, for example—could be made more beautiful, it was. "It contributed to how I see value," Simon says. "I like to feel that I'm in something with heart in it."

This September she will take over the entire rotunda at the Guggenheim with "Taryn Simon: Father Country, I Do Love You." "It's the story of one man and everything he touched," Simon tells me. That man is an unnamed federal agent whose life will be reflected in 42 individual artworks, each gesturing to the ripple-like consequences of his actions. The exhibition, made up of text, photographs, video, and sculpture, is dedicated to Simon's father, who lived all over the world and was diagnosed with Alzheimer's disease before the full dimension of his life was evident to his daughter. The show "encompasses a vast range of themes," says Guggenheim curator of performance and media Nat Trotman, "but at its core it is about the way the life of one individual—which could be any of us—touches those of so many others, opening up a galaxy of stories."

Much of Simon's work is like this: startlingly intimate and powerfully political. In 2016 she filled the Park Avenue Armory with professional mourners, brought in from all over the world—a stunning installation, grief turned outward and monumental. Simon shows me one of her outfits, its apron embroidered with a name. One of the mourners made it for her—a trace of her art quietly making its way into what she wears.—**CHLOE SCHAMA**

CLOSET CASE

A skirt with suspenders and a balloon-sleeve blouse constitute Simon's daily ensemble. Here, a dozen examples from her collection.

LEG UP

A new generation of women designers is reinventing the slim look of American denim. By Jane Herman.

Tight, body-hugging jeans are nothing new. By the time I began grappling with them, circa 2008, they'd long been associated with James Dean's sex symbol status and the rock-rebel style of punk icons like Debbie Harry. Still, when *skinnies,* as we called them, came back into fashion in the aughts, I was both shocked and confused. Here was this fit, so daring and so specific, that clung to the curves of our legs like cellophane. For me, uncomfortable didn't even begin to describe it. As someone whose whole life had been anchored by denim (my dad is the former LA retailer Ron Herman; *jeans are in our genes* was the joke), I felt unmoored, questioning not only my weight but the shape of all my tops. I wrote about my denim anxiety in this same space just shy of 20 years ago, declaring skinny jeans a "tricky little trend" and wondering how I'd deal with it—or if it would even last.

Of course, skinny jeans didn't just last; they dominated for more than a decade—I dealt with it by avoiding them in favor of foolproof 501s, more slim than skinny—until denim's reliable 10-ish-year pendulum swung in the other direction, toward wider legs and looser fits. So why a comeback now? Part of it, of course, is the simple desire for newness. One never *needs* a new pair of jeans every season: They're jeans; they're made to last a long time. The rumblings of a return to skinnies started when Miuccia Prada showed little low-riders in Miu Miu's fall 2024 collection. In truth, it was too soon and too tight, even for an audience who wore compression-level stretch denim not that long ago. Today, I suspect we're picking up where we left off right before the sweatpant-centric pandemic seemed to slam the door on anything clingy with a restrictive fit.

Flash back for a moment to Hedi Slimane's '70s-inspired spring 2020 collection for Celine, which landed in stores just as COVID hit. That type of jean—high on the waist, pipe-shaped down the leg, and authentic-looking (i.e., made of 100 percent cotton)—is now having a renaissance and, compared to baggies and barrels, feels powerful and smart. I loved it then and I love it now. It makes me think of Nili Lotan's Joan, one of the best straight legs on the planet today.

"I don't like to use the word *skinny,*" says designer Jac Cameron, who has the niche and increasingly popular Agnes jean in her line, Rùadh (pronounced "*roo*-ah"). A mid-rise style with a button fly, lean leg, and a little slit at the hem's outseam, Agnes is trim but "definitely not a legging vibe," Cameron explains. The game changer: >188

NOT FADE AWAY

Adut Akech goes long and lean in Dsquared2 jeans. Photographed by Tyler Mitchell for *Vogue,* April 2020.

PHOTOGRAPHED BY TYLER MITCHELL, *VOGUE*, APRIL 2020. ART PARTNER/TRUNK ARCHIVE.

PRADA
PARADOXE
PRADA
MILANO
ZENDAYA

PRADA
MILANO
DAL 1913

PRADA
MILANO
PRADA
MILANO
PRADA
MILANO

ZENDAYA

PRADA
PARADOXE

THE REFILLABLE FRAGRANCES

THE INTENSE & SWEET CHEMISTRY,
THE NEW FRUITY FLORAL EAU DE PARFUM

The fabric is 75 percent recycled cotton and 25 percent postindustrial waste. "It's got this great body to it, this incredible hold—it's gutsier, heavier, and looks like an authentic rigid."

Ossou ("*oh*-sue") designers Nina Khosla and Talia Shuvalov agree. "It's not about the resurgence of the spray-on jean," Shuvalov says. "It's about creating something that's tailored and refined, that still has a bit of air around the leg but offers you this slim effect." Ossou's Noon jean—a non-stretch high-rise with a cinched waist and more tapered leg—evokes the Lady Levi's jeans of the 1930s, which the May 1935 edition of this magazine declared *the* thing to wear while vacationing in what was then called the Far West. (I repeat: Tighter jeans are nothing new.)

But while these new jeans are all technically slim, they are absolutely not the same. Even within the trend, there's real variety, which is so much more inviting than the deep sea of same old skinnies we got swept away in last time. "The whole thing is just straighter," says Aflalo's Yael Aflalo about her best-selling Brontë. It's extremely lean top-to-bottom compared to Noon and Agnes. "We've kept the more classic denim measurements—narrow waistband, longer fly—and fine-tuned the shape of the leg," she explains. (In denim-speak, *classic* typically implies a 501 fit. That Hailey Bieber's been seen wearing bum-hugging vintage Levi's recently is not a coincidence.)

"I think it's easier for people to take a slimmer silhouette back than it was for them to accept it the first time around," says Jamie Haller, a 2026 CFDA/*Vogue* Fashion Fund finalist whose namesake line has two exceptional formfitting styles: the Slim Stovepipe and the Low. Also—and this is important—a lean silhouette is now far from the only option. Haller still has a Slouch and a Bell Crop, for example. Slim, barrel, bootcut, wide-leg, low-rise, high-rise, flared…. We're living in a moment where all fits can be heroes.

Even within the trend, there's real variety, which is so much more inviting than the deep sea of same old skinnies we got swept away in last time

There's one more important shift in the landscape that you may have noticed: Many of the brands making the new cuts are led by women—a welcome change from the male designers dominating the all-skinny world of the 2010s. Haller, who worked at Guess and NSF before launching her own line, and Cameron, who cut her teeth at Calvin Klein and cofounded AYR, are now running their own shows, and they're not alone: An entire generation of creative hard-workers who embarked on their careers during the premium denim boom of the early 2000s—and even *made* those male-gaze skinnies of the 2010s—has now stepped into their own.

But starting a jeans line is one thing. Nailing it—as these women have—is something else. Their edge: A closeness to the fit that men, no matter how skilled or legendary they may be, simply cannot own. Aflalo wear-tests everything. Cameron is in direct communication with her customers via text. Haller is her own fit model. It may sound obvious, but a subjective eye is insightful. The connection converts—and finally, with great enthusiasm (relief, even), I'm embracing the change. □

PHOTO: STUDIO AL. © LG ARTS CENTER.

WORLD'S STAGE

A new interpretation of *The Cherry Orchard* lands in New York.

Anton Chekhov's *The Cherry Orchard*, written at the start of the 20th century, hinges on a specific moment in Russian history—the decline of the aristocracy and the rise of a middle class. Can you transplant that to 21st-century Seoul? Such was the challenge writer and director Simon Stone, who brings his interpretation to Manhattan's Park Avenue Armory this month, set for himself. "I looked at that society," Stone says of contemporary Korea, "and the way that power trickles down. It felt like imperial Russia."

This *Cherry Orchard* is more *Parasite* than Stanislavski—offering a novel spin on the class dynamics of the original. "All of those lines about the aging nanny who's still living with the family, the housekeeper, the chauffeur that's just a little bit of an idiot but they keep him in the family—all of that stuff happens in Korea," says Stone, who is known for working in languages not native to him. This production will be performed in Korean with English subtitles—with Park Hae-soo (*Squid Game*) and Jeon Do-yeon (a Cannes winner for 2007's *Secret Sunshine*) in starring roles, both making their New York stage debuts. Stone asserts that Chekhov's comedy transcends any vernacular: "A lot of jokes are funny because people know what it's like to have a mother that nags them."

Stone has a roving, transnational background. This play, he says, was adapted "by a Swiss-born, Austrian-residing Australian for Korean actors, some of whom have never left Korea." He's also known for upending theatrical convention. His provocative 2018 interpretation of Federico García Lorca's *Yerma* became a modern fertility parable; a startling 2020 *Medea* with Rose Byrne and Bobby Cannavale placed the tragedy on a disorientingly bright white stage, the better to distill its impact. Here he is working with the avant-garde architectural designer Saul Kim (in Kim's theatrical debut) to erect a cutaway building—seen at left—illuminated like a giant dollhouse. No matter the cultural background, family dysfunction is entertaining to observe.—**CHLOE SCHAMA**

ISABEL
MARANT

ISABEL MARANT

WHAT IF...

your feet stopped
counting the minutes
until you got home.

WHAT IF...

every step felt more
like a sneaker
than a stiletto.

WHAT IF...

your heels were designed
by people who
actually wear them.

sneex
BY SARA BLAKELY

ANTHROPOLOGIE

SCOOP
Born in NYC. Styled Everywhere.
Only at Walmart

WHERE THE WILD THINGS ARE

Is the best design no design at all? Chloe Schama digs into chaos gardening.

Recently, reels of time-lapse flower beds have surfaced on my phone's screen: humble patches of dirt, tilled between the siding of a house and a stretch of lawn, rapidly transformed into a riot of color, a feast of bobbing blossoms. This is "chaos gardening"—a social-media-fueled movement that has been gaining traction among a certain kind of gardener wanting to stage a small-scale rebellion against the strictures of horticulture on a patch of dirt. No need for planning, plotting, skill, or experience. You don't even need to step into a nursery; a dusty packet of seeds from the hardware store will do.

Chaos gardening is a few steps removed from the free-form, untamed idea of the English garden aesthetic that might seem its spiritual antecedent. It's not even really akin to the modern-meadow movement, which emphasizes native plants and ecological restoration and usually involves considered deployment of specific species. Rather, the practice puts faith in chance, whim, and inspiration. It embraces serendipity and celebrates mistakes. In one TikTok video (with 4.6 million views and counting), a gardener who goes by The Chaos Gardener describes her four-year-old daughter's adventure with a purloined packet of sunflower seeds, which she surreptitiously planted in her sandpit—resulting in the tallest and sturdiest stalk her mother had ever seen. "Here's the trick," says popular TikTok gardener Farm Boy James, while flinging handfuls of dried lentils and black-eyed peas over his shoulder, "there isn't a trick." >206

I PREDICT A RIOT
Where a handful of seeds, improvisation, chance, and whimsy collide, a (social media friendly) garden may grow.

PHOTOGRAPHED BY ALLAN POLLOK-MORRIS, *VOGUE*, DECEMBER 2014.